

States **ANDHRA PRADESH**

staggered completion of the irrigation projects so that the gestation period can be reduced and return of investments begins sooner by prioritising the funding. Audits of all welfare schemes initiated since 2004 are underway and those in the rural development, civil supplies and Panchayati Raj departments have already found about 46 lakh ineligible beneficiaries.

But YSR loyalists deprecate this pragmatic approach and other detractors lay the blame at Rosaiah's door to suggest that he is even scuttling YSR initiatives. What the chief minister and the mandarins of the state finance department are doing is to release funds from the treasury keeping in mind the overall financial position of the state which, in effect, involves cutting back on

allocations. As a result, some schemes run short while others do not reach a significant portion of the beneficiaries. The state is not in a position to enhance the supply of rice to BPL families from 24 to 30 kg nor to increase the supply of free power to farmers from seven to nine hours—the only promises of populist profligacy made by the Congress to ride back to power in 2009.

A scheme intended to pay the college fee of indigent students whose parental income is less than Rs 1 lakh was to cover 24.6 lakh beneficiaries but more than half of them did not get it though there was a budgetary sanction of Rs 2,883 crore. Pruning became inevitable because of the overall financial stress and only a marginal amount reached the students in whose name individual bank accounts were opened.

The pioneering cashless health cover for the poor, the Rajiv Arogyasri Scheme, provides domiciliary health care, including expensive surgeries at state expense. Nearly 2.4 crore families have received medical benefits but given the nature of health



(RIGHT) JAGANMOHAN'S ODARPU YATRA HAS ENSURED THAT YSR'S VISION FOR ANDHRA IS PURSUED AT A STEADY RATE; ROSAIAH AT THE PRAJAPATHAM JOURNEY

SADDLED WITH FINANCIAL TROUBLES, ROSAIAH'S PLANS TO RESTRUCTURE ARE COMING UNSTUCK DUE TO THE DELAYS IN SHUFFLING THE MINISTRY.



problems and the expense, whatever is done remains inadequate. While extending quality health care through the extended referral system, Rajiv Arogyasri has inadvertently helped revive what seemed a dysfunctional primary health care system and raised some hope of deliverance from an increasingly unaffordable health regime for the poor. The state has provided Rs 925 crore for the cashless treatment during 2010-11, the same as last year. If coverage is its strong point, cost control is the weakness of Rajiv Arogyasri. Knowledgeable critics insist the referral hospitals, mostly corporate, end up billing higher fees and, in some cases, "over treating" patients with more than the